

1st Outline: A tentative outline of the titles of the major sections of your capstone project and a (short) narrative explaining what is going to go in each section.

Introduction

Question

Motivation

Literature review (where applicable)

Hypotheses

The introduction is where the audience is introduced to the linguistic puzzle. This includes my Big Questions as well as why the audience should care about my Big Questions. I will likely include some literature review here.

Linguistics papers, especially syntax ones, generally don't really operate like some other fields where the hypothesis is stated at the beginning and you have to get to the end to see what the results were. Most linguistics papers have a sentence or two at the end of the introduction which is essentially "What I found was [xyz]".

Methods

What type of corpus did I want and why?

How did I assemble the corpus?

- What variables did I use and why?
- What software did I use?
- Tagging?
- Annotations?

What was the source of my data?

What statistical tests did I do and why?

The methods section is just how I did what I did, what choices I made along the way, and why I made those choices. For my study in particular, this will mostly look like talking about how I assembled the corpus and why I did it in the way that I did. There will also be a section about the statistical tests I ran, but these will be simpler as my project is mostly about the creation of a corpus.

Results

Summaries, graphics, statistical tests

What did I find?

The results section is usually pretty short in the linguistics papers I've read. Often full of figures and explanations of what they mean. This section only addresses literally what I found, and not

anything about whether this is what I expected to find, or why it's interesting, or anything very analytical.

Discussion

Why is what I found cool / unique / important?

Does it line up with my hypotheses?

Does it raise questions in the field?

What can be done after this?

The discussion is usually the final section (perhaps a conclusion at the end in some papers, but it's not usually necessary) and is where all the analysis of the Results section is done. A lot of linguistics work is looking to the future, so my paper will likely end with me talking about what I hope can be done in the future with the corpus I create, with the implication being that other researchers in the field will do much of this work rather than specifically work I intend to pursue.

Gries, S., & Paquot, M. (2020). *Writing up a Corpus-Linguistic Paper*. Springer Nature.

https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-46216-1_26